HACK876 × DIGICEL FOUNDATION

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Every child deserves a turn at building the future.

The Digicel Foundation believes every child deserves access to technology and the future it brings. Hack876 gives students one day to take that technology and build something of their own.

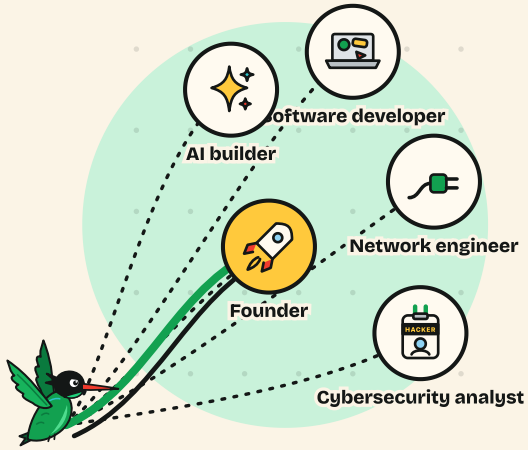
Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)



80	9	1
STUDENTS	SCHOOL NETWORK	DAY

One day to build something that should exist.

What if young Jamaicans experienced themselves as builders before anyone told them what career they should have?



Before the degree.

Before the first job.

Before anyone hands them a title.

There is usually a first moment when someone realizes: I can build this.

For most young people, that moment arrives late, if it arrives at all.

Hack876 is designed to create more of those moments.

Meet Hack876.



Hack876 is a one-day build competition for approximately **80 secondary-school students** from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4, roughly 20 teams in all, on Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative).

Teams pick a real problem, use modern tools including AI, get guidance from mentors, and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges. It is not a school assignment and there is no answer key.

Our **9-school network** in Kingston is made up of the schools where the Hack876 team currently has relationships and can coordinate most reliably. It is not an exclusive eligibility list.

BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

03 NOT JUST APPS

A hackathon is bigger than software.

Hack876 is an open build competition. Teams choose the problem and the medium.

Some will write code. Some will wire circuits. Some will design a service, a business or a tool nobody has thought of yet.

A team might build:

- A piece of software
- An AI tool
- An automation
- A data product
- A tool for small businesses
- Hardware
- A robot
- A physical prototype
- A resilience solution
- Something none of us expected

The medium does not matter.

The instinct to create does.

You open the lab doors. We give students a reason to stay and build.

Hack876 is a place where that access turns into something a student made with their own hands.

DIGICEL FOUNDATION MISSION

"We aim to mobilise and distribute resources across Jamaican communities to improve education at the early childhood, primary, secondary, and tertiary levels, increase access and opportunities for persons with special needs, and stimulate sustainable entrepreneurial activity."[1]

One of the Foundation's goals is To Build Minds: improving literacy and access to technology in schools across Jamaica.[1]

Its Girls in ICT work aims to narrow the technology gender gap. In May 2026 it hosted a full-day AI hackathon for girls from Denham Town and Tivoli Gardens high schools.[2]

In April 2026 it sponsored an AI hackathon for secondary-school girls across western Jamaica, themed AI for Development: Girls Shaping the Digital Future.[3]

Opening a Smart Lab at the NAZ Children Centre, Charmaine Daniels said the Foundation believes digital inclusion is a right.[4]

It has brought Smart Labs to teachers' colleges, because, in her words, every doctor, engineer or scientist begins with a teacher who believed in them.[5]

Two decades of putting technology in students' hands.

SINCE 2004

US$51.6 million. 1,750 projects.

Invested across education, community development and special needs, with 889,381 lives impacted.[1]

SMART LABS

28 labs and counting.

Smart Labs established in schools and institutions, alongside 34,030 students reached through the Safer Internet Together programme.[1]

2025 TO 2026

Labs for the people who teach.

Five Smart Labs at teacher training colleges and four in special-needs institutions, plus more than 100 young Jamaicans in a digital technology and coding programme.[6]

GIRLS IN ICT · 2026

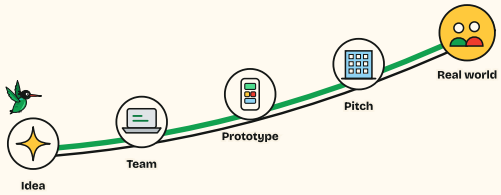
A full day of AI, built by girls.

Girls from Denham Town and Tivoli Gardens high schools spent a day applying AI to climate challenges, mentored by engineer and board director Antoinette Heirs.[2]

SUMMER 2025

Hands-on STEM over the holidays.

Support for the Captain Altitude Aviation Summer Camp and the STEM Builders Learning Hub STEAM Camp.[7]



The Foundation already builds the rooms and runs the days. Hack876 adds a place where students from many schools build side by side.

06 THE SCHOOL NETWORK

9 schools. One room.

Hack876 begins with the schools where we already have relationships and can coordinate most reliably for the inaugural staging. Formal confirmations are still in progress, and the network is not an exclusive eligibility list.

- Hillel Academy
- Campion College
- Jamaica College
- Immaculate Conception High School
- Wolmer's
- Ardenne High School
- American International School of Kingston
- St. Andrew High School for Girls
- St. George's College

There are two natural homes for this inside the Digicel Foundation.

The Foundation's formal grant calls open in set windows for community groups, schools and non-profits. We are asking directly because Hack876 is a single day, but we are happy to follow whichever route suits the Foundation.[8]

PATH 1 · THE FOUNDATION

A direct partnership with the Digicel Foundation

- Fits the To Build Minds goal: technology and learning in schools.
- One gift that helps support the day itself, not a long programme.
- Recognition for the Foundation, not Digicel products.
- Reported back in students, schools and working builds.

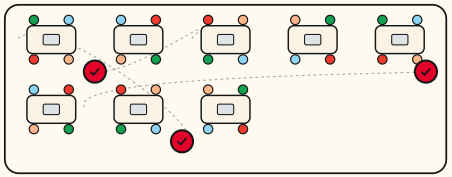
PATH 2 · GIRLS IN ICT

An extension of the Foundation's Girls in ICT work

- A suggested award that carries Girls in ICT into a mixed, multi-school build day.
- Complements the Foundation's own girls' hackathons rather than repeating them.
- Board and staff mentors on the floor alongside the students.

The Digicel Foundation's contribution does not have to be purely financial.

PEOPLE IN THE ROOM.



01
Staff on the floor

A few Digicel Foundation and Digicel volunteers to help with check-in, timekeeping and keeping teams moving.

02
Judges

People from Digicel's network, cybersecurity and digital teams to judge alongside our panel.

03
Mentors who have done it

Engineers such as board director Antoinette Heirs, who already mentors girls on ICT careers, if they are willing.

04
A word to open the day

Charmaine Daniels or someone from the Foundation on why access to technology matters for every student.

05
Safer internet, in a minute

A short, practical safer-internet moment drawn from the Safer Internet Together programme.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

No phones, SIMs, data plans or other Digicel products or offers are marketed to students. Many participants are minors.

No student data, phone numbers or contact details are collected or shared for the Foundation or Digicel. Any recap uses group numbers and school-approved photos only.

Volunteers, mentors and judges work in open, supervised spaces under the host school's safeguarding rules.

The honest answer to the visibility questions.

Will the Digicel Foundation be visible? Yes, across event materials, programming and post-event storytelling, at a level that matches the partnership.

Is the audience relevant? It is the next generation of Jamaican builders, professionals and leaders, met early.

Can it build longer relationships? Yes, through people, schools and a second year, not through leads.

WHO IS IN AND AROUND THE ROOM

Ambitious secondary-school students
Approximately 80 of them, from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form.

Parents and families
Who see who showed up for their children.

Teachers and school communities
Across our network of 9 schools in Kingston.

Future university students
Making choices about what to study and where.

Future founders and professionals
Meeting the Digicel Foundation early, and in the right way.

Many participants are minors. We will not promise leads, reach, impressions or data.

Become a Platinum Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

J$1,000,000+

PLATINUM PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876

Platinum is flexible: it helps support prizes, meals and the day itself in one gift. If a smaller gift fits the Foundation better this year, a contribution at any level is welcome.

Any amount within the level is welcome. It is a flexible contribution toward the event, with no naming rights attached.

PROPOSED RECOGNITION

Digicel Foundation

Platinum Partner · Inaugural Hack876

Closest Hack876 tracks: Learn, Wellbeing, Resilience, Move

CONTRIBUTION LEVELS. ANY AMOUNT WITHIN A LEVEL IS WELCOME.

Bronze Partner	Silver Partner	Gold Partner	Platinum Partner SUGGESTED
J$50,000 to below J$200,000	J$200,000 to below J$500,000	J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000	J$1,000,000+

In-kind & Community Support: devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and contributions below J$50,000.

What each level receives.

Bronze Partner

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

Silver Partner

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

Gold Partner

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement
- A dedicated sponsor feature
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

Platinum Partner

J$1,000,000+

OUR SUGGESTION

- The most prominent sponsor placement
- An agreed opportunity to take part in the programme
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

Speaking, mentoring, presenting an award and judging are subject to suitability and programme capacity. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

WHAT A CONTRIBUTION COULD SUPPORT

- **The event overall.** Used where it helps the students most.
- **Prizes.** Contributes toward the prizes for the top teams.
- **Equipment.** Helps support the equipment teams build with.
- **Event production.** Helps support staging, sound and the room.

A sponsor can support the event overall, or agree a specific use with the Hack876 team. No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

WAYS TO HELP WITH A PRIZE

The planned prizes are iPad per student (up to 4); AirPods Pro per student (up to 4); gift card per student (up to 4). Any of these helps:

- **Donating the item**
- **Donating some of the quantity needed**
- **Gift cards or store credit**
- **A discount on the purchase**
- **A monetary contribution toward buying it**

In-kind & Community Support

For devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and for contributions below J$50,000.

A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

AN IDEA, NOT YET A HACK876 AWARD

Digicel Foundation Girls in ICT Award (suggested)

A suggested award for the strongest build from a team where girls lead the technical work, carrying the Foundation's Girls in ICT commitment into Hack876.

13 A DIRECT LINE

There is no faceless sponsorship process here.

This proposal is for **Charmaine Daniels, Chief Executive Officer, Digicel Foundation**.[1]

If the Digicel Foundation is interested, we can decide together what involvement should actually look like.

QUESTIONS WE WOULD ANSWER TOGETHER

- ✓ How is this different from the girls' AI hackathons we already support?
- ✓ Will students without their own laptop be able to take part?
- ✓ What exactly would a Gold gift pay for, and what will you report back?
- ✓ When is the date, and when would you need a decision?
- ✓ Should this come through a grant call or as a direct partnership?
- ✓ How do you protect students, especially the minors?

A conversation, not a workload.

Deliberately focused.

Our vision is national. This inaugural staging does not have national-event resources, and we will not pretend it does.

Approximately 80 students. A school network of 9 in Kingston. One day, done properly.

Build the first one well.
Learn from it.
Earn the right to make the second one bigger.

2027

Help make the first Hack876 happen.

No multi-year commitment required.

FUTURE POSSIBILITIES, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

- A Girls in ICT award that returns each year.
- Teams from Smart Lab schools joining Hack876 as it grows.
- Safer Internet Together sessions in participating schools before the day.
- Student teachers from Smart Lab colleges volunteering as mentors.
- A signpost from Hack876 to the Foundation's own girls' AI hackathons and STEM camps.



HACK876 × DIGICEL FOUNDATION

Somewhere in that room may be a future founder, engineer, designer or leader.

They do not need us to decide who they become.

They need an opportunity to begin.

HELP US BUILD THAT OPPORTUNITY.

We would love to explore the right first step with Charmaine and the Digicel Foundation team.

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hack876.com info@hack876.com

SOURCES

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2. Jamaica Observer, "Digicel Foundation empowers Denham Town and Tivoli High girls with AI skills (May 23, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/05/23/digicel-foundation-empowers-denham-town-tivoli-high-girls-ai-skills/
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8. Digicel Foundation, "Salute 21 Grants Campaign (August 2, 2025)." www.digicelfoundation.org/jm/en/news/digicel-foundation-targets-digital-literacy-and-silver-economy-in-new-salute-21-grants-campaign

A private partnership proposal prepared for Charmaine Daniels, Chief Executive Officer, Digicel Foundation.